

Writers on the block

Creating WORLDS with words

Believe it or not, people were writing books long before Harry Potter came around. Some of them were pretty good, too.



William Shakespeare (1564–1616)

School children all over the world might think this English writer is **BORING**, but with the likes of **Hamlet, Othello, King Lear, and Macbeth**, he created some of literature's *greatest characters*. He was a real wordsmith, too, inventing around 1,700 of the words we use today.

Shakespeare's wife and children were all illiterate

Voltaire (1694–1778)

This French writer just couldn't stop. He wrote more than **2,000 books** and pamphlets, and an incredible 20,000 letters. **He used his wit to criticize** the king and government, and spent most of his life in **FEAR OF BEING JAILED**.

